Here's a refreshing soup for a warm summer's day. You could use romaine lettuce or even a bunch of watercress instead of chicory, if you prefer.

chicory gazpacho

SERVES 4 **PREP** 15 MINS PLUS CHILLING **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

1 large orange
2 heads white chicory
2 slices bread, crusts removed
1 garlic clove, coarsely chopped
4 scallions, trimmed and coarsely chopped
1 large beefsteak tomato, peeled, quartered, and seeded
2 cups cold vegetable stock
2 tbsp olive oil, plus extra for garnish
2 tbsp white balsamic condiment
4 large basil leaves
salt and freshly ground black pepper

1 Thinly pare the zest of half the orange. Cut in thin strips and boil in water for 1 minute. Drain, rinse with cold water, and drain again. Set aside for garnish. Finely grate the zest from the remaining orange, squeeze the juice into a bowl, and set aside.

2 Cut a cone shape out of the base of each head of chicory and discard. Separate the heads into spears. Reserve four of the smallest spears for the garnish. Coarsely chop the remainder.

3 Soak the bread in water for 2 minutes. Squeeze out some of the moisture then put the bread in a blender with the chopped chicory, garlic, scallions, tomato, stock, olive oil, white balsamic condiment, and the basil leaves, the orange juice and finely grated zest. Purée the soup in a blender or food processor then season to taste. Chill until ready to serve.

4 Ladle into four bowls, and drizzle with a little olive oil. Garnish each with a tiny chicory spear and a few strands of blanched orange zest. Serve cold.